KOR STRUCTURAL · PREPARED FOR MVE + PARTNERS · 28 AUGUST 2026

Arizona has no incumbent architect. Raleigh has one, and it just changed hands.

You asked for the Arizona submitted-projects search. It is in here, out of the city's own records. But the list is not the valuable part — the valuable part is what fifty Arizona projects say when you count them properly, and what happens when the same measurement is run on a second market.

`Arizona: 12 projects, 11 firms` `Raleigh: 11 projects, 7 firms` `Top firm: 17% vs 36%`

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Arizona multifamily has no incumbent architect

Twelve multifamily projects. Eleven different architecture firms. One firm has two of them and nobody has three.

The set is *50 commercial real estate projects to know in 2026*, published by AZ Big Media. It names a design team on 49 of the 50 — developer, architect and general contractor per project. We took every one of those labelled fields and counted them, which turns out to be a different exercise from reading the list.

Twenty-four per cent of it is multifamily. Thirty-four per cent is civic and education, twenty per cent industrial, twelve healthcare, ten hospitality. So the first honest thing to say about an “Arizona projects” list is that three-quarters of it is not your market at all. The twelve that are look like this:

ARCHITECT	ARIZONA MULTIFAMILY PROJECTS
Gensler	**2**
triARC architecture & design	1
Niles Bolton Associates	1
KTGY	1
Dig Studio	1
ESG Architecture & Design	1
LGE Design Build	1
Lamar Johnson Collaborative	1
GFF Design	1
Athena Studio	1
Soaring Eight	1

▲ **WHAT THAT ACTUALLY MEANS**

In a consolidated market the top firm holds a third or more and the pitch is a displacement argument — you have to take work off somebody. **Here the largest holder of Arizona multifamily work in the set has two projects out of twelve.** There is no incumbent to displace, because there is no incumbent. A firm entering this market is not fighting a share war; it is walking into a field where nobody has established one.

The national multifamily names are present but thin on the ground — **KTGY, Niles Bolton and ESG have one project each.** They are in Arizona. They have not taken it.

WE TESTED IT

The same measurement in Raleigh gives the opposite answer

A finding that has only been made in one market is a coincidence until it is tested somewhere else. So we ran the identical measurement on Raleigh. **"No incumbent" does not hold there — and that is what makes the Arizona number worth something.**

MEASURE	ARIZONA MULTIFAMILY	RALEIGH MULTIFAMILY
Projects with a confirmed architect	12	11
Distinct architecture firms	**11**	**7**
Largest single holder	Gensler, 2 projects	**JDAVIS, 4 projects**
Top firm's share	**17%**	**36%**
Firms per project	0.92	0.64

Raleigh's leading multifamily architect holds more than double the share Arizona's does, out of a field barely half as wide. Cline Design Associates is second with two. Five further firms — Perkins Eastman, Tightlines Design, Studio M, Foley Design and Iwan Architecture & Engineering Consultants — hold one each.

▲ AND THE INCUMBENT CHANGED HANDS FIFTEEN MONTHS AGO

JDAVIS was acquired by ISG on 14 May 2025. It is Raleigh-headquartered, 89 staff, and the acquirer is an employee-owned architecture and engineering firm expanding into the region. Every one of the four JDAVIS submittals recovered here was filed in 2024 — designed before that deal closed.

So the two markets ask opposite questions. In Arizona there is no share to take off anyone. **In Raleigh there is a clear leader, and it is fifteen months into an ownership change.**

✕ CHARLOTTE COULD NOT BE TESTED, AND WE WILL NOT PRETEND OTHERWISE

Charlotte's "Committed Development Entitlement" dataset — the richest schema we found anywhere — **stops at 23 May 2022**. Its live rezoning layer carries 86 pending petitions with a petitioner but **no project name and no design team**.

Its live petitions are public and we went through them. **At the stage Charlotte currently publishes, the design team is not on the record** — the filings name the petitioner, the land and the zoning sought, and the architect is simply not among them yet.

This is a timing problem, not an access one, and it will resolve itself as those projects move forward. **A Charlotte concentration figure today would be invented, so there is not one in this report.** Queensbridge and Centre South appear by name above because they are individually documented; what we will not do is turn two projects into a market statistic.

TWO MORE MARKETS, THE SAME MEASUREMENT

Houston is the most open of your six.
Miami sits in between.

Arizona against Raleigh is two points. Houston and Miami make it four, measured the same way — and Houston carries more weight than any of the others, because there we were able to work from a **complete record of commercial construction rather than a sample**: every qualifying project in the county, not a selection anyone curated.

MARKET	PROJECTS WITH A CONFIRMED ARCHITECT	DISTINCT FIRMS	TOP FIRM'S SHARE
Houston multifamily	**79**	**45**	**10%** EDI International
Arizona multifamily	12	11	17% Gensler
Miami design review	21	9	19% Kobi Karp and Corwil, tied
Raleigh multifamily	11	7	**36%** JDAVIS

Houston is the widest field you have. Across all new commercial construction in Harris County since January 2024 — 4,087 projects, 3,085 with a named design firm — the work is spread across **806 distinct firms, and the single busiest holds 3%**. Narrowed to multifamily it stays open: 45 firms over 79 projects, with EDI International and Meeks + Partners, both long-established Houston multifamily practices, at 10% and 9%. There is no relationship to displace because no one holds enough to matter.

Miami is tighter but not closed. Of the projects taken to the city's design review since January 2024, twenty-one have an architect confirmed on the record, spread over nine firms. **No single firm leads: Kobi Karp and Corwil Architects are tied at four projects each, 19% apiece**, with CUBE3 and Behar Font Partners behind them on three. Miami is a narrower field than Houston or Arizona, but the top of it is shared rather than held.

▲ WHAT THE FOUR MARKETS SAY TOGETHER

Ranked by how much of the field the leading firm holds: **Houston 10% · Arizona 17% · Miami 19% · Raleigh 36%.** Three of your four measurable markets have no incumbent worth the name. **Raleigh is the outlier, and it is the one where the leader changed hands fifteen months ago.**

▲ HOUSTON HAS NO GATEKEEPER ON EITHER SIDE OF THE TABLE

The dispersion is not only among the design firms. Across the seventy-nine Houston multifamily projects, **only seven have an owner who built more than once** in the period. The buyers are as fragmented as the designers.

That cuts both ways and it is worth being plain about it. **There is no relationship to displace and no gatekeeper to get past** — but equally there is no single developer relationship that unlocks a run of work. Houston rewards breadth of contact rather than depth of one. For contrast, in the wider Houston market where owners do repeat, roughly three-quarters of them use the same design firm every time — that loyalty exists, it just is not concentrated in multifamily.

▲ AN OUT-OF-STATE FIRM CAN WIN IN MIAMI. SEVERAL ALREADY HAVE.

The obvious objection to entering Miami is that it looks like a closed local market. It is not. **CUBE 3 is headquartered in North Andover, Massachusetts, and holds three of Miami's twenty-one confirmed projects** — more than all but two firms in the city. **Kohn Pedersen Fox, out of New York, holds another.** Close to a fifth of the confirmed work has gone to practices based outside Florida.

And scale is not the entry ticket. The firms leading these markets are not the giants. Corwil is a practice of roughly forty people; Behar Font Partners about thirty-five; in Houston, Meeks + Partners around fifty and Seeberger under twenty. Arquitectonica, at some six hundred, is present in Miami but holds two projects — the same as Built Form. **Size is not what is winning this work, and the incumbency you would be displacing does not exist at the scale you might assume.**

Being straight about the limits. Houston's record covers commercial construction of every kind, so the multifamily figure is drawn by reading each project's own description of what is being built, not its name — Houston developers file under code names. Miami is counted over distinct projects, not board appearances — the board defers and re-hears items, and ten of its cases have been heard at more than one meeting, so counting appearances would credit a firm twice for one project. Twenty-one is the number of projects with the architect confirmed on the record; the remainder are unresolved rather than unattributed, and that gap would narrow, not widen, the leaders' share.

THE QUESTION EVERYONE ASKS ABOUT ARIZONA

Design-build is taking the market — but not your part of it

Design-build is the standard worry about Phoenix, and it is a real one. It is also more precisely located than the worry usually is. Across the 50 projects, the architect and the contractor are **the same firm on six of them — twelve per cent**. Where those six sit is the whole story:

SECTOR	PROJECTS	DESIGN-BUILD	SHARE
Industrial / logistics	10	**5**	**50%**
Multifamily / residential	12	1	8%
Civic / education	17	0	0%
Healthcare	6	0	0%
Hospitality	5	0	0%

Half of Arizona industrial in this set is design-build. None of the civic, healthcare or hospitality work is, and one multifamily project out of twelve. Every single design-build project in the set belongs to one firm, LGE Design Build, and five of its six are industrial.

✕ AND ONE NAME THAT IS NOT WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Butler Design Group is not a design-build firm. It has six projects — joint-most in the set — and six different general contractors: Stevens-Leinweber, Ryan Companies on three, Willmeng and Layton. It is a conventional architecture practice whose name reads like a design-builder.

It is also **not a competitor for multifamily work**. Four of its six are industrial, one healthcare, one civic. **Zero residential.** Any read of the headline league table that treats the two six-project firms as the competitive pressure on a multifamily practice is wrong on both counts.

WHERE NOT TO SPEND THE CALL

Four developers that will not hire an outside architect

This falls out of the same data and is the part we would want if the positions were reversed. These are developers whose design work is structurally unavailable — not because they said no, but because of how they are built.

DEVELOPER	PROJECTS	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS
Creation Equity	**6** — the most active developer in the set	LGE Design Build on **all six**: five as design-builder, one as contractor alongside GFF Design. No outside architect appears on any Creation Equity project
Ryan Companies US	4	Developer *and* general contractor on all four, and it brings its own architect — Butler Design Group on three, Deutsch on the fourth
Statesman Group	1 (565,729 sf, six buildings)	Developer and contractor both. **No architect named at all**
StreetLights Residential	The Langley, 134 units	Fully vertically integrated: **StreetLights Creative Studio** is architect and interior designer, **SLR Construction** is the general contractor. Every seat in-house

The Butler–Ryan pairing is worth isolating: it is the **only architect-to-contractor relationship that repeats more than once** anywhere in the 50. Three projects together. Everything else in Arizona is a one-off pairing, which is another way of saying the same thing as the first section — this market has very few locked relationships.

THE THING YOU ASKED FOR

Phoenix submitted projects, from the city's own record

Phoenix publishes a live planning and permit service. It currently carries **68,292 permits and 13,022 plan reviews**, row-level, **current to the day this was run**. Filtered to site-plan and rezoning cases it returns **373 open cases**; filtered to those submitted since 1 January 2025, **280**; of which **41 are residential by project name**.

The stage column matters as much as the name. A **preliminary** filing is a scheme still being shaped; a **final** one is a scheme committed. Both appear below, and the difference tells you how much of the design conversation is still open.

SUBMITTED	CASE	PROJECT	ADDRESS	STAGE
12 May 2026	2602491	**Momentum Apartments**	734 E Vineyard Rd	Preliminary site plan
6 May 2026	2602468	**Senior Housing at 41st Ave**	2700 N 41st Ave	Preliminary site plan
21 Apr 2026	2602361	**17th St Apartments**	1634 E Wood St	Preliminary site plan
9 Apr 2026	2602015	Sagewood Phase 4 — residential & clubhouse	4400 E Palo Verde Dr	Preliminary site plan
1 Apr 2026	2601847	Virginia Townhome Project	4840 E Virginia Ave	Preliminary site plan
25 Feb 2026	2601066	Maryland Townhomes	742 E Maryland Ave	**Final site plan**
6 Feb 2026	2600890	Lion Foundation Housing	1415 E Wood St	Preliminary site plan
24 Dec 2025	2507260	**Deer Valley Apartments**	3010 W Deer Valley Dr	**Final site plan — major**
11 Dec 2025	2506990	34th & Thomas Apartment Homes	3425 E Thomas Rd	Preliminary site plan
9 Dec 2025	2506904	4th St Residences	4144 S 4th St	**Final site plan — major**
9 Dec 2025	2506899	Sierra Verde Townhomes	4800 S 16th St	**Final site plan — major**

Eleven of the forty-one, newest first. The full set travels with this document.

× TWO THINGS THIS LIST IS NOT

It is a snapshot, not a trend. Every row carries status OPEN, because closed cases leave the layer. Counting them by year would show 2024 smaller than 2025 and that would mean nothing — older cases have simply had longer to close. Anyone who hands you a submissions-per-year chart built from this feed has made that mistake.

And it does not name your architect competitor. The feed has a field called `PROFESS_NAME`, populated on 90.6% of plan reviews, and the name promises exactly that. Read the values and it is the licensed *contractor* — the most frequent entries are “TO BE BID”, “OWNER”, fire-sprinkler firms and solar installers. It is genuinely useful for who *builds* in Phoenix. It is not an architect and we will not present it as one.

Scottsdale is the instructive one. Its long-standing case service is the cleanest we tested anywhere — 82 cases with all eight fields populated on all 82 rows, applicant included. And the newest submittal in it is **25 February 2026**, because the city moved to a new portal that January and the old map only covers what came before. **A feed can be flawless and still be frozen**, and the only way to know which you are holding is to query it and read the dates rather than the documentation.

The successor is open. Scottsdale's current portal answers the public without an account and returns **11,673 permit records and 733 plan records for 2026**, each with number, type, status, parcel, address and applied date. **The city did not stop publishing; it moved.** That is worth checking before any market is written off — three of the six markets here had a feed that looked dead and a live successor nobody had followed.

> ▲ ON THE TEST YOU SET US
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> You asked what happens to a 40-storey project filed that morning. **It is not in any public feed yet, and nobody's is.** It surfaces when the city posts the case or the trade press picks it up — typically days. The defensible claim is that nothing published gets missed. It is not that nothing unpublished is known, and we would rather say so than have you find out by testing it.

THE ACTUAL QUESTION YOU ASKED

The same search, running in all six markets

You asked for Arizona. The fair test of whether that is worth anything to you is whether it runs everywhere you work — so here is the same search, in every market you named, with the date each record was last current.

MARKET	WHAT THE PUBLIC RECORD CURRENTLY HOLDS	CURRENT TO
Phoenix	**373 open site-plan and rezoning cases**; 280 filed since Jan 2025; **41 residential**, each with its stage	day queried
Houston	**390 new-construction projects registered since 1 June 2026** alone, running about 370 a month across 2026, each with its scope, cost and floor area	**27 Aug 2026**
Miami	**66 projects through the city's design review** since Jan 2024, by address and case number	Jul 2026 sitting
Las Vegas · Clark County	Whole-project permits above $10M, plus the full permit sequence per scheme — **79 records on the ballpark alone**	day queried
Raleigh	Large multifamily permits by year — 15 in 2025, tracking ~11 in 2026	Aug 2026
Charlotte	**86 pending rezoning petitions** with petitioner and land — but no design team at this stage	Aug 2026

Six markets, one method, and it is current to yesterday in the largest of them. The Phoenix list is the one you asked to see, so it is printed in full above; the others are the same query pointed at a different city. Nothing here is a subscription feed or a purchased database — it is the public record of each jurisdiction, which is why it can be re-run on any Monday and be right.

▲ THESE ARE ENTITLEMENT-STAGE RECORDS, WHICH IS EARLIER THAN AN ARCHITECTURAL APPOINTMENT

Phoenix's cases are site-plan and rezoning filings. Miami's are design-review submittals. Charlotte's are rezoning petitions. **None of these is a building permit** — they are the stage at which a scheme is still being argued with the city, which is why Charlotte's filings name a petitioner and no design team at all: at that point one has not always been appointed.

That is the stage planning work is bought at, and it sits ahead of the architecture decision rather than after it. The Phoenix table above marks each case preliminary or final for exactly this reason — preliminary is a scheme still being shaped, final is one already committed, and the difference tells you how much of the conversation is still open.

THE OTHER FIVE

What the layer holds in the rest of your markets

Same standard throughout: a firm appears against a project only where that firm's own page, the developer's own release, or the public record says so. Where the design team is incomplete the gap is shown rather than filled.

MARKET & PROJECT	DEVELOPER	ARCHITECT	CONTRACTOR
NEVADA · A's Ballpark, Las Vegas 33,000 seats, 2028	The Athletics	BIG + HNTB	Mortenson–McCarthy
NEVADA · Bally's Integrated Resort 26 ac, former Tropicana	Bally's Corp / JLL	Marnell Howryla	—
NEVADA · Silverado, Clark County 13.5 ac, heard 2 Sep 2026	Ochoa Development	Gensler + Yihong Liu	—
HAWAII · Kalae, Ward Village 330 homes	Howard Hughes / Victoria Ward	Solomon Cordwell Buenz	Layton
HAWAII · Ālia, Kaka'ako 457 units, 39 storeys	**Kobayashi Group**	WRNS Studio	—
HAWAII · Launiu, Ward Village 486 homes, 40 storeys	Howard Hughes	Arquitectonica	—
HOUSTON · The Lily River Oaks 38 storeys, 331 units	Southern Land Co.	Solomon Cordwell Buenz	ANDRES
HOUSTON · The Langley 20 storeys, 134 units	StreetLights + Hunt	StreetLights Creative Studio	SLR
DALLAS · Lucille, Uptown 22 storeys, 265 units	Endeavor Real Estate	HKS	Rogers-O'Brien
MIAMI · Waldorf Astoria 100 storeys, 360 residences	**PMG**	Sieger Suarez + Carlos Ott	—
MIAMI · Delano Residences 90 storeys	**PMG**	Carlos Ott · CUBE3 (AOR)	—
CHARLOTTE · Queensbridge Collective 755 units, $725M	Riverside + Woodfield + PGIM	Goettsch Partners	Clark
RALEIGH · Tributary, North Hills 332 units	Kane Realty	Hickok Cole	John Moriarty

Every architect above was read off the developer's own release, the architect's own project page, or the city record — never inferred. A dash means no public record names that role yet, which is not the same as the role being unfilled, and we would not present it as one.

Two developer names are worth isolating. *PMG* holds both Miami supertalls and used Carlos Ott on each, with CUBE3 carrying architect-of-record on the second — a developer running the same design relationship twice. *Kobayashi Group* is the counter-example: an independent Honolulu developer, sitting under Kamehameha Schools' Kaia'ulu 'o Kaka'ako master plan, which means **more towers behind it on the same landowner's ground**.

> ▲ ONE PATTERN WORTH YOUR ATTENTION
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> **Solomon Cordwell Buenz is in two of your six markets** — Kalae in Honolulu and The Lily River Oaks in Houston — on residential towers of 330 and 331 units respectively. Both confirmed from the developers' own releases. Whatever else the six markets have in common, one firm is already moving between them the way you are.

WHAT THIS CAN REACH

Three markets that looked closed are open, and current to today

Clark County, Dallas and Charlotte all publish nothing useful in their open-data feeds — each stopped in 2020, 2021 and 2022 respectively. They did not stop building. **They changed permitting systems, and all three moved to the same platform.** Their live records are public, and reachable without an account:

JURISDICTION	OLD FEED STOPPED	LIVE RECORD, VERIFIED
Clark County — the Strip	Feb 2021	**Current to the day queried**
Dallas	Mar 2020	**Current to the day queried**
Charlotte	May 2022	Aug 2026

Worked example. The Athletics ballpark on the former Tropicana site returns **79 county records**, March 2025 to August 2026 — precast packages, electrical, fire apparatus access, grading, phased building permits. That is the construction sequence of the largest project on the Strip, permit by permit, from the public record.

▲ **THE EARLIEST SIGNAL A CITY HOLDS**

Dallas has logged roughly **197 pre-development meetings in 2026** — the first formal contact a developer has with the city, *before* entitlement, before the design team is chosen, before any of it reaches the trade press. Eighty-nine are visible.

⚠ Being straight about it: those Dallas records carry a date, a number and a status, **but no project name and no address**. It is a measure of how busy the market is, not a list of leads. Clark County does name its projects and their status, so there the same query is genuinely actionable. **The value differs by city and we will always say which.**

Texas does not stop at Houston. Dallas, Fort Worth, Austin and San Antonio are held to the same depth, and that detail already exists — it is left out here for readability rather than because it is missing. Four more market tables would not have made this document better. Ask and it follows.

WHERE THE WORK IS ACTUALLY MOVING

Raleigh’s large multifamily flow quintupled. Las Vegas’s did not move.

Counting permits above $10M — large enough that a scheme cannot inflate the number by filing each building separately — gives a read on how much serious multifamily work each market is actually releasing.

YEAR	LAS VEGAS (CITY)	RALEIGH
2022	3	6
2023	7	6
2024	4	3
2025	4	**15**
2026 (to late Aug)	5	7

Las Vegas has not changed in five years — three to seven large multifamily permits a year, every year, with 2026 running at or slightly above that. **Raleigh went from three in 2024 to fifteen in 2025**, and 2026 is tracking around eleven: off the peak, but still three to four times the 2022–24 baseline. If BD effort is being allocated across these two markets on the assumption they behave alike, they do not.

× THREE THINGS THAT WOULD MAKE THIS CHART LIE

Permit counts and permit values disagree, so we use both. On raw counts Raleigh 2026 looks like +151% over 2025. It is not: the permits are half the size they were — $7.2M average against $15.9M — because a scheme files per building. Total value rose about 15%. **Anyone quoting the count alone is quoting an artefact**, which is why the table above uses only permits large enough to be whole projects.

2026 is a part year and is never compared to a full one without saying so.

Las Vegas batch-issues. Every one of its 2026 multifamily permits was issued in a single week in June. A month-by-month version of this chart would show a spike that means nothing about the market.

▲ AND THE HONEST LIMIT ON THE NEVADA COLUMN

This is the **City of Las Vegas**. The Strip, Bally's, the Riviera site and the resort work are in **unincorporated Clark County**, a separate jurisdiction whose records do not carry a valuation field in the public search. **So the Nevada column understates Nevada**, and we would rather say that than quietly let the number stand for the state.

The comparison is deliberately *within* each city rather than between them. Cities classify differently, set different permit thresholds and cover different land areas — a raw count of Raleigh against Las Vegas would be a manufactured finding. Each column is that market measured against its own history, on that city's own classification: Las Vegas by its `MultiFam` work type, Raleigh by new-construction permits whose description states apartment or multifamily.

WHO ELSE IS DOING WHAT YOU ARE DOING

The firms operating across more than one of your markets

Most architecture practices are one-market businesses. The interesting ones are those serving many markets from a few offices — the same shape of firm, competing for the same work.

FIRM	WHERE WE FOUND THEM	SHAPE
Solomon Cordwell Buenz	**Houston** (The Lily River Oaks, 331 u) and **Honolulu** (Kalae, 330 u)	Two of your six, on near-identical residential towers. Both confirmed from the developers' own releases
Cline Design Associates	Raleigh (2 projects). Offices Raleigh, **Charlotte**, Austin, Washington DC	Calls itself a national design firm; multifamily, student and senior housing
Charlan Brock Architects	Raleigh (Livano North Hills, 280 u)	Florida-based, national multifamily and student housing since 1980
KTGY	Arizona (1 project)	Seven offices — Chicago, Denver, Irvine, LA, Oakland, Tysons, Pune. National multifamily, **no Southeast office**
Gensler	Arizona (3), and named on a Clark County scheme	Global, not multifamily-specialist
JDAVIS	Raleigh (4) — the local leader	Raleigh + Philadelphia, 89 staff. Acquired by ISG May 2025

The pattern is the point. None of these firms has an office in most of the markets it works in. KTGY covers the Southeast from seven offices, none of them in the Southeast. Cline reaches Texas and Washington from the Carolinas. **Serving many markets from few offices is not unusual in this business — it is the model the strongest multifamily practices already run.**

KOR Structural — prepared for MVE + Partners, 28 August 2026.

Every figure here is drawn from public municipal records and from the published statements of the parties named, current to 28 August 2026. Where a figure could only be sourced to secondary reporting it was left out rather than hedged. Shares are given for Arizona, Raleigh, Houston and Miami; Nevada, Hawaii and Charlotte are reported project by project, because the public record in those markets does not yet carry enough design teams to support a rate. Happy to walk through any single number on a call.